



HANNAH COCKROFT

(Great Britain)

Wheelchair racer Hannah Cockroft will line up at her seventh World Championships, aiming to extend an already formidable haul of 16 world gold medals. Her dominance has been most evident in the 100m T34 (seven titles) and 800m T34 (five titles), while she has also claimed two apiece in the 200m and 400m T34, underlining her range across sprint and middle-distance events.

Shortly after her birth, Cockroft suffered two cardiac arrests, which resulted in brain damage and physical deformity in her feet, leaving her with weak hips. She was introduced to wheelchair sports at the age of 12 and took up wheelchair racing three years later. Inspired by Canadian Paralympic great Chantal Petitclerc, Cockroft has etched her name into para athletics history with her numerous medals and records.

The 33-year-old has four Paralympic gold medals in the 100m T34 to go with five more gold medals in the 200m, 400m and 800m across the years.

She currently holds the world records in the 100m, 200m, 400m, 800m and 1500m T34 events.



EZRA FRECH

(USA)

The USA track-and-field athlete might not yet have the resume as some of the illustrious names in the mix, but the 20-year-old is expected to hog the headlines in India.

Frech was born without most of his left leg, which was later amputated, and with only a finger on his left hand. He played multiple sports as a child before taking up athletics at the age of eight.

Frech competes in high jump and sprint events and will arrive at the Worlds with two Paralympic gold medals in the 100m T63 and high jump T63 in Paris last year.

He made his Worlds debut at 14 before going on to win gold in the high jump T63 in Paris in 2023, but finished only with a silver the following year.

The world record holder in his high jump event, Frech could be on the cusp of becoming the next big para athlete in track and field.